ElmerPad Outline Manager Tag System Specification

Purpose

Provide a lightweight, project-level tagging system for organizing and locating files within an Outline Manager project without modifying the underlying files.

The tag system shall support text, Markdown, images, PDFs, remote files, and any future document types.

Tag Storage

Each Outline Manager file container may contain an optional list of tags.

Examples:

```
Chapter1.md
    #draft #chapter1 #novel

Map.png
    #reference #map

Research.pdf
    #biology #important
```

Tags are stored within the `.epol` project file and are not written into the linked files.

Tag Syntax

Supported formats:

```
#draft
#todo
#reference
```

or

```
draft, chapter1, novel
```

Internally, tags are normalized by:

- trimming whitespace
- converting to lowercase
- removing duplicates

- sorting alphabetically for storage

Outline Search

The Outline Manager search bar shall support:

- filename search
- folder name search
- tag search

Typing:

```
draft
```

or

```
#draft
```

shall return every Outline item containing that tag.

Results are displayed as a flat ordered list while preserving the original project hierarchy internally.

Selecting a result opens or previews the associated file.

Tag Pick List

The search field includes a drop-down list of all defined tags.

Features:

- alphabetically sorted
- searchable
- displays usage count

Example:

```
chapter1 (4)

draft (12)

important (3)

reference (21)

todo (7)
```

Selecting a tag immediately filters the Outline.

Tag Editing

Tags may be edited from:

- Add File
- Rename/Edit Properties
- Context Menu
- Keyboard shortcut (optional)

Tag editing shall never modify the underlying document.

Multiple Tags

A file may contain any number of tags.

Example:

```
#chapter4 #draft #dialog #needs-review
```

Searching any tag includes the file.

Search Outside the Outline Manager

Use Ctrl-Alt-F to launch **Open by Tag** menu

Tag search shall be available globally throughout ElmerPad.

Examples:

- Global “Open by Tag”
- Workspace search
- Command Palette
- Quick Open dialog

The user should not need to open the Outline Manager to locate tagged files.

Recent Searches

Maintain a short history of recent tag searches.

Example:

```
Recent

#draft

#reference

#todo

#chapter3
```

Favorites

Allow users to pin frequently used tags.

Example:

```
Pinned

#todo

#draft

#reference
```

Pinned tags appear at the top of the tag picker.

Boolean Search (Future)

Support simple expressions:

```
draft review

draft -complete

reference pdf
```

Equivalent to:

```
draft AND review

draft NOT complete

reference AND pdf
```

No advanced query language is required.

Automatic Tags (Optional)

ElmerPad may automatically maintain system tags that are hidden from normal editing.

Examples:

```
:text

:markdown

:image

:pdf

:remote

:modified

:readonly
```

These enable searches such as:

```
:image

:markdown

:remote
```

without requiring user-defined tags.

Workspace Support

Tags are scoped to the current workspace by default.

An optional “Search All Workspaces” mode searches every workspace and displays workspace names with the results.

Example:

```
Novel

Chapter3.md

Research

Timeline.pdf

Journal
```

`Daily Notes.md`

Performance

Searching shall operate entirely on Outline metadata.

The contents of linked documents are not scanned during tag searches.

Search results should appear instantly even for large projects.

Design Goals

- Zero impact on document formats
- Keyboard-first workflow
- Minimal visual clutter
- Fast enough for e-ink devices
- Consistent across all supported file types
- Extensible without changing the `.epol` format